



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 09

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Pneumatic Nailer & Stapler Safety

OVERVIEW:

Pneumatic finish nailers, brad nailers, and staplers are high-speed fastening tools that are used constantly in finish carpentry. They can drive fasteners through materials and into hands, feet, and other workers with no warning. Treating these tools with the same respect as any firearm is not an

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. The contact safety tip on your nailer is the most important safety device on the tool. It must make contact with the work surface before the trigger can fire the tool. Never defeat this mechanism by taping it down, wiring it open, or removing it. If the safety tip is missing, damaged, or not functioning correctly, tag the tool out of service immediately and report it to your supervisor.
2. Always disconnect the air supply — not just lower the pressure — before clearing a jam, changing fasteners, or performing any maintenance on a pneumatic nailer. Nails can be discharged during clearing if the tool is still pressurized. When clearing a jam, make sure the tool is pointed in a safe direction and keep your face away from the nose of the tool in case a fastener ejects
3. Fasteners ricochet. When you drive a nail into a hard knot, a hidden metal fastener, or at a shallow angle, the fastener can deflect and travel in an unexpected direction. Always wear safety glasses when using nailers. Eye injuries from ricocheted fasteners are entirely preventable and completely permanent. No exceptions on this one.
4. Never point a nailer at another person, even as a joke. Never carry a nailer with your finger on the trigger. Never rest a nailer on your foot or thigh while moving. When setting the nailer down between uses, set it down with the nose pointed away from people. These are basic muzzle discipline habits, the same ones you would follow with a firearm, and they apply here for exactly the same

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is the procedure on this job for reporting a damaged or malfunctioning nailer?
- Q2: Has anyone ever been injured by a nailer or seen a ricochet happen? Walk us through it.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Disconnect air supply before clearing jams or changing fasteners
- Never bypass the contact safety tip — it is not optional
- Keep fingers away from the nose of the tool while firing
- Never point a nailer at yourself or another worker
- Wear safety glasses — fasteners can ricochet off hard surfaces

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 09

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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